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Virginia House of Delegates Floor Session, Regular Session, Friday, February 13, 2026

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- Official floor video (House of Delegates archive, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=A7UVvEWbLvk
- LIS House minutes: https://lis.virginia.gov/session-details/20261/minutes-list/H

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[00:10:53] House will come to order. Members, please take your seats. Head page. House is now in session. All persons not entitled to privileges of the floor, please retire to the gallery.

[00:11:13] The members will rise and be led in prayer by the Most Reverend Barry C. Nesdout, Bishop of the Catholic Diocese of Richmond, and remain standing for the Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America, which will be led by the Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring.

[00:11:28] Let us pray. Eternal God, Father of all mercy and source of every good gift, We come before you in this historic chamber where the work of governing this commonwealth begins anew. We praise you, Lord, who took on our human nature to reveal the infinite dignity of every person and who calls us to love one another as you have loved us.

[00:11:53] Come, Holy Spirit, advocate and guide. Descend upon these women and men gathered here with the fire of your wisdom and the gentle breath of your compassion. Enkindle in their hearts the gifts of understanding, counsel, and fortitude that they may discern your truth amid the complexities of our time.

[00:12:14] We give you thanks, O God, for the heritage of this commonwealth, a place where religious liberty was first championed as a sacred right, rooted in the conviction that conscience is answerable to you alone. May that same spirit of freedom inspire these legislators today.

[00:12:33] Not freedom for its own sake, but freedom ordered toward the service of all, especially those in need. Lord, in a time of differing views and passionate convictions, Teach these servants to listen with humility, to speak with charity, to seek dialogue that bridges divides rather than widens them.

[00:12:51] Raise their vision above partisan lines to the universal call of justice and mercy, ideals that transcend ideology and unite us as one people under your providence. Heavenly Father, guide their deliberations with your light.

[00:13:09] Grant them courage to choose what is right, even when difficult, and peace in pursuing the true good of every Virginian. I ask this prayer through Jesus Christ, our Lord, who lives and reigns with you and the Holy Spirit, one God, forever and ever. Amen.

[00:13:27] The members will answer the roll call by indicating their presence on the electronic voting board.

[00:14:06] Clerk will close the roll. Mr. Speaker, a quorum is present. Pursuant to House Rule 3, I have examined and approved the General House of Delegates for February 12, 2026. Most of the resolutions under Rule 39 pursuant to the provisions of Rule 40 are now in order.

[00:14:25] Does the clerk have any announcements or communications? No communication. Simple announcement. It was reminding the body today is the last day to confirm gubernatorial appointments made during the recess. Accordingly, in this first portion of the morning hour, pursuant to House Rule 40, the Speaker requests you use your request to speak button for the agenda items listed for reference up on the voting board.

[00:14:45] Delegate from Hanover, Delegate Wyatt. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen of the House, today's invocation was kindly provided by the most reverent Barry C. Nestout, the 13th Bishop of the Diocese of Richmond.

[00:15:05] Bishop Nestout was appointed by Pope Francis on December 5th, 2017. Bishop Nestout was installed a month later on January 12th, 2018 at the Cathedral of the Sacred Heart in Richmond. Growing up in Bowie, Maryland, Bishop Nestout attended both Catholic and private schools, Graduated from Bowie High School in 1980 after entering the University of Maryland.

[00:15:31] He was accepted into the School of Architecture and earned a bachelor's degree in 1984. The following year, he began seminary studies at Mount St. Mary's Seminary and received a Master of Divinity and a Master of Arts and Moral Theology.

[00:15:48] He was ordained into the priesthood for the Archbishop of Washington, Archdiocese of Washington, by Cardinal James Hickey on June 24, 1989, at St. Matthew Cathedral in Washington, D.C.

[00:16:03] Pope Benedict XVI appointed him Auxiliary Bishop for the Archdiocese of Washington Anticular Bishop of Leavenworth on November 18, 2008. His Episcopal ordination took place on December 29, 2008, selecting Christ Our Hope as his Episcopal motto. He serves on many national Catholic boards and committees and is a fourth degree member of the Knights of Columbus, a member of Order of Malta, and the equestrian order of

[00:16:40] Holy Secular Cur of Jerusalem. It's especially fitting that we welcome Bishop Nestle out today, Friday, as next Wednesday we as Christians begin the Lenten season, the 40-day period of prayer, reflection, repentance, and the spiritual renewal of hope as we prepare for Easter, the resurrection of

Christ, giving all Christians the hope of everlasting life in the presence of God. We are fortunate to have two Catholic churches close to the Capitol, Mr. Speaker.

[00:17:15] The Pro Cathedral of St. Peter, dedicated in 1834, is less than a block away on Gray Street, with Masses Monday through Friday at 12 noon, Sunday at 8.30 and 10.45. And St. Patrick in Churchill, dedicated in 1860, with Masses on Saturday at 5.30 and Sunday at 10.45.

[00:17:39] Mr. Speaker, I hope all members will have a chance to visit these historic Catholic churches while in Richmond and renew the hope and love of Christ in one another.

[00:17:50] Mr. Speaker, I hope members will join me in thanking His Excellency Barry C. Nestow for the invocation, and he is joined today by Father Michael Bolin, the Diocesan of Richmond, Vicar General, and I understand we do also have folks from the Virginia Catholic Conference in the gallery today observing, and I ask members of the House, would you please give these folks a warm House welcome?

[00:18:19] Welcome. Welcome to the Capitol, and thank you for that fantastic prayer this morning.

[00:18:37] The delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Carlson. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a motion. The delegate has the floor. I move that the House take up out of order H.J. 133. Clerk will report a resolution. House Joint Resolution No. 133, commending the Honorable J. Harvey Wilkinson III.

[00:18:57] The delegate from Albemarle, Delegate Carlson. I am trying to get this in good posture for the Virginian of the Year on Wednesday, so I would move adoption of the resolution. shall the house adopt house joint resolution number 133 all those in favor say aye all opposed no the resolution is agreed to thank you delegate from winchester delegate wiley thank you mr speaker i rise for a motion delegate has the floor thank you mr speaker i move that h.r 72 found on page 47 be taken up and i would like to speak to that motion clerk will report a resolution

[00:19:30] house resolution number 72 celebrating the life of leo michael schweiger delegate from winchester to Delegate Wiley. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Leo Michael Schweiger, a devoted public servant, community volunteer, advocate, and beloved resident of Winchester, passed away on November 1st, 2024. He was born on August 25th, 1933 in Lenexa, Kansas. Alongside his eight siblings, was raised on a family dairy farm where he developed humility, work ethic, generosity that would define his life. Mr. Schweiger earned a bachelor's degree in English from St. Benedict

[00:20:08] College in Atchison, Kansas, before proudly serving his country, the United States Air Force, as a photo intelligence specialist in Japan, achieving the rank of staff sergeant and cultivating a lifelong passion of photography. And following his honorable military service, Mr. Schweiger dedicated more than 30 years to the federal government as an inspector with the former U.S. Customs Service, the United States Department of Treasury, serving his distinction at the Port of Houston.

[00:20:38] He subsequently served as an instructor at the United States Customs Training Academy in Georgetown and is a director of management development at the U.S. Customs Service Headquarters in Washington, D.C. In recognition of his exceptional career and unwavering commitment to public service, Mr. Schweiger was awarded the Albert Gallatin Award, the highest career service honor of the United States Department of Treasury, presented personally by the Secretary of Treasury, James Becker III, upon his retirement in 1985.

[00:21:06] Drawn by the history of the Nishandoah Valley, Mr. Schweiger made Winchester his home in retirement and continued to serve others tirelessly through volunteerism and civic engagement, as well as enriching the community through his passions for photography and gardening. He was a dedicated volunteer at the State Arboretum of Virginia at Blandy Experimental Farm and a lifelong member of the Winchester Little Theater, where he generously contributed his time and talents to maintaining the grounds and enhancing community spaces.

[00:21:34] Living with a lifelong hearing impairment caused by osteocorosis, Mr. Swigert became a steadfast advocate for individuals who were deaf and hard of hearing, confronting discrimination with grace, wisdom, courage, and championing equality and understanding throughout his life.

[00:21:52] And in 1997, Mr. Swigert was appointed by Governor George Allen to advise the Virginia Department for the deaf and hard of hearing and state leadership on issues affecting Virginians with hearing loss. He was subsequently reappointed by the multiple governors, reflecting the respect he earned across administration and political lines.

[00:22:10] Mr. Swiger was a highly respected member of the Winchester Host Lines Club, where he led the hearing aid recycling program for more than a decade, earning recognition as a Melvin Jones Fellow in Line of the Year and enduring honor of having the annual Leo Swiger Hearing Award named in his memory.

[00:22:27] Above all, Mr. Schweiger was a humble man who put his others first, lived with integrity, and left a lasting legacy of service, compassion, and quiet leadership that continues to inspire communities across the Commonwealth. He will be fondly remembered and greatly missed by numerous family members and friends.

[00:22:48] Mr. Speaker, I ask that we pass this resolution and we move when the House adjourns today to adjourn in honor and memory of Mr. Leo Michael Schweiger. Delegate from Winchester, Delegate Wiley, moves the adoption of House Resolution No. 72, celebrating the life of Leo Michael Swiger, and he moves that the House adjourn in honor and memory of Leo Michael Swiger.

[00:23:13] Those in favor of the motion shall rise. The motion is agreed to. Delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Cousins. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[00:23:30] I rise for an announcement. Delegate, ask the floor. Thank you. Mr. Speaker, I have accepted Delegate Fowler's challenge to raise donations for Feed More and also to collect food. So this week we are kicking off the 2026 Legislative Food Drive to benefit Feed More and the Federation of Virginia Food Banks. Feed More has been serving Central Virginia for 55 years with a focus on providing emergency assistance for neighbors struggling with hunger through their comprehensive programs and agency network.

[00:24:01] Delegate Fowler and I would like to ask that you bring non-perishable food items to collection boxes that are outside of our offices. You can find us both on the 11th floor, and again, we are also collecting donations. Thank you. Delegate from Warren County, Delegate Oaks.

[00:24:18] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a motion and an introduction. Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House take up out of order H.R. 85 on page 48 of today's calendar.

[00:24:35] Clerk will report a resolution. House resolution number 85, commanding the Front Royal Little League 12U All-Stars. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the resolution. I request to speak to the motion. The delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise today with great pride to recognize a team that has captured not just a championship title, but the heart of an entire community.

[00:25:00] The Front Royal Little League state champion, 12-year-old All-Stars, if you'd please rise. These young athletes, Mr. Speaker, didn't just win games. They showed sportsmanship, discipline, grit, teamwork, and heart.

[00:25:16] They showed up in the heat. They fought through hard innings and put their teammates before themselves every single time. This is what champions do. But championships are not one alone. I want to especially recognize their outstanding coaches, Jesse Henry, Shane Wines, and manager Joe Cook, who poured countless hours into mentoring, encouraging, and shaping these players not into just better athletes, but into young leaders. Coaches, thank you.

[00:25:47] for investing in these kids and for modeling dedication character and sportsmanship this team has made front royal and all of warren county incredibly proud our businesses followed the games they invested in our kids families packed the stands neighbors rallied around them and this season this team reminded our entire community what it means to come together and cheer for something bigger than ourselves. To the players, you are champions, not only because of the trophy you earned, but because of the way you represented your hometown and the Commonwealth of Virginia.

[00:26:24] Mr. Speaker, one of those students was in the ESPN top 10 plays of the day. Yeah, we were excited to watch our kids on ESPN. I asked that on behalf of Delegate Pence and myself that we give the Front Royal Little League state champions, a warm house welcome.

[00:26:46] The delegate from Warren, Delegate Oates, moves that we adopt House Resolution No. 85.

[00:27:08] All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. Congratulations, I don't need one of them jerseys. Pursuing to House Rule 30, the journal shall reflect that the following members are way on pressing personal business on a granted leave from today's session.

[00:27:28] Delegates Clark, Converse Fowler, Knight, and Seboe. The clerk will announce the next order of business. Ms. Speaker, members of the House, second portion of the morning hour is reserved for the announcement of member request of legislation from an uncontested calendar to the regular calendar. I am aware of only one in the category.

[00:27:44] Second, uncontested, Delegate Maldonado's House Bill 678 on page 24. HB 678 is out of the block and over to the regular calendar. That's the only one I'm aware of. Clerk, shall I announce the next order? Third portion of the morning hour is for the announcements of member request of legislation goodbye for the day.

[00:28:01] And if such, the subsequent motion by the Majority Leader, there are four. The second category on the live calendar today, House Bill's third reading regular, Delegate Downey's House Bill 841 on page 9, and Delegate Converse Fowler's House Bill 5 on page 10.

[00:28:20] Both of those are by for the day. Going forward to a request to go by for the day. The second reading regular, Delegate McClure's House Bill 524 on page 33, that is a request to go by for the day.

[00:28:36] And in that same category, fast-forwarding to page 37, Delegate Lopez's House Bill 936. Those requests are by Delegate Tran. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Heron. Mr. Speaker, a move that the legislation as announced by the clerk go by for the day.

[00:28:54] Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Heron moves that the legislation as announced by the clerk go by for the day. If there's many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The clerk shall announce the next order of this. And the fourth and final portion of the morning, our reserve for member requests for points of personal privilege. Delegate from Spotsylvania, Delegate Cole.

[00:29:11] Good morning, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a point of personal privilege. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, in recognition of Black History Month and tomorrow's Valentine Day, I honor the life and legacy of Mildred Dolores Jeter Loving. While the story of Loving versus Virginia has been immortalized in books, movies, documentaries, songs, and even an opera, Mildred Loving rarely sought the spotlight, preferring the simple joys of family life. Mrs. Loving was a woman of quiet courage and profound

[00:29:44] dignity whose love transcended the unjust barriers of her time. Born Mildred Dolores Jeter on July 22nd, 1939 in Caroline County, Virginia, Mrs. Loving grew up in the small community in Central Point. Mildred met Richard Loving in the early 1950s in Central Point. Family, friends, and neighbors who grew up just mild apart, they began courting years later. It was their marriage in 1958 that is most well known. Mildred and Richard married on June 2, 1958, in Washington, D.C.,

[00:30:21] not in their home of Caroline County, in order to avoid Virginia's Racial Integrity Act of 1924, which criminalized interracial marriage. On July 11, 1958, just weeks after marrying, local police raided the loving home in the middle of the night, tore the couple from their bed, and criminally charged Mildred and Richard for the crime of interracial marriage.

[00:30:47] Mildred and Richard pleaded guilty to violating and were sentenced to one year in prison, which was suspended on the condition they leave their home in Virginia and not return together for 25 years. Mrs. Loving endured exile from her beloved Virginia home for nearly a decade, separated from family and community, yet never wavered in her conviction that her marriage was just and right. With remarkable strength and determination, Mrs. Loving became the driving force behind the legal challenge that would change America.

[00:31:23] On June 12, 1967, in Loving v. Virginia, the United States Supreme Court ruled unanimously that laws banning interracial marriage were unconstitutional, striking down such laws in 16 states and affirming that marriage is one of the basic civil rights of man.

[00:31:42] After the ruling, Mrs. Loving and her family returned to Virginia and raised three children in Caroline County. Though she rarely sought the spotlight, Mildred understood the profound impact of her case, speaking out in support of marriage equality for all loving couples, saying, I believe all Americans, no matter their race, no matter their sex, no matter their sexual orientation, should have that same freedom to marry.

[00:32:08] Mildred passed away on May 2, 2008, but her life continues to inspire movements for justice, equality, and the fundamental right to love freely and without fear. We honor the memory and legacy of

Mildred Dolores Jeter Loving, whose courage, grace, and unwavering love helped bend the arc of history towards justice.

[00:32:30] And we commit ourselves to upholding the principles for which Ms. Loving stood, dignity, equality, and the fundamental human right to love and be loved. Mr. Speaker, I ask that members of the House join me in honoring and celebrating National Loving Day, Valentine's Day, and Mrs. Mildred DeLoas-Jita Loving.

[00:32:57] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, I rise for a brief point of personal privilege. Make it short. The delegate has the floor.

[00:33:14] Mr. Speaker, members of the House, so last week at this time, the very confused delegate from Roanoke got up to tell us he was very confused because he had gone looking for the most recent revenue report, the December of 2025 revenue report on the Department of Finance website, And allegedly, it had been removed.

[00:33:33] It had disappeared from the website, never to be seen again, and expressed his shock and concern and dismay that for some reason, somebody in the administration seemed to be trying to hide from the public the revenue reports. They'd just gone away from the website.

[00:33:49] Well, Mr. Speaker, members of the House, our friend, the new Secretary of Finance, was watching that day, and he heard that speech and reminded me that first, he actually had delivered a paper copy of the December report to the delegate from Rona. He went on to explain that sometimes the simplest explanation is the most likely, which is that when they were transitioning the website from the old administration to the new administration, somebody was cutting and pasting, and they missed the December link. When they were cutting over here to paste it over there, we've all done this before, right? You don't drag it quite far enough.

[00:34:26] You miss a month's worth of stuff, and so it didn't make it over. So if you go on to the Department of Finance website right now the December revenue letter is there but not only that Mr. Speaker we now have a brand new as of yesterday January revenue letter but Mr. Speaker in case the delegate from Roanoke is still having trouble with his computer and can't pull it up the Secretary of Finance has given to me and authorized me to deliver to you a gift-wrapped copy of the January 2026 revenue letter and report I'll make sure that you get us Mr. Speaker I thank you, members of the Delegate.

[00:35:07] The Delegate from Roanoke, Delegate McNamara. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I rise for a point of personal privilege. I hope it's going to be shorter than that brief point of personal privilege. It will be.

[00:35:22] The Delegate has the floor. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I would like to say to the Delegate, I do accept his apology. I looked with great excitement when the January revenue letter came out, and I will look forward to talking about it in the near future.

[00:35:42] Thank you very much. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The clerk will mercifully call the calendar. With mercy, Mr. Speaker, I come before you on this Friday, the 13th, day before Valentine's Day, for the calendar of the Virginia House of Delegates, page first category, live category House bills on third reading uncontested calendar, 15 bills in the uncontested third reading final passage block, which are as follows,

[00:36:11] House Bill 66, 195, 580, 643, as well as House Bill 777, 794, 795, 849, House Bill 865, 885, House Bill 957, 1142, 1284, 1357.

[00:36:27] And the last bill in the third reading, uncontested calendar block, top of page 9, is House Bill 1472. The block is now before you. Shall the bills pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:36:49] Ayes 96, noes 0. House 96 noes zero. The bills pass. Continuing with the calendar, a new category, House Bill's on third reading regular. Approximately 20 bills in this category. Page 9 of the printed calendar, House Bill 841 and House Bill 5 are by for the day.

[00:37:08] Therefore, the first bill in this new category is House Bill 28, which relates to voter registration. A regular periodic review of registration records. 90-day quiet period before all primary and general elections. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[00:37:31] Ayes, 61, noes, 35. Ayes, 61, noes, 35. The bill passes. House Bill 125 relates to public elementary and secondary schools, teachers, terms of employment, re-employment of teacher who has not received continuing contract status, written notice required.

[00:37:49] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes, 60, noes, 34. Ayes, 60, noes, 34. The bill passes.

[00:38:05] House Bill 127 relates to court appearance of a person not free on bail. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:38:21] Ayes 84, no's 10. Ayes 84, no's 10. The bill passes. House Bill 189 relates to certain student assessment requirements, calculation of final course grade repeal. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:38:44] Ayes 86, no's 10. Ayes 86, no's 10. The bill passes. House Bill 247, a relation to deferred disposition in a criminal case, persons with autism, intellectual disabilities, or developmental disabilities expungement. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:39:11] Ayes, 59, noes, 36. House 59, noes, 36. The bill passes. House Bill 293, relating to corporations, limited liability decentralized autonomous organizations. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:39:36] Ayes, 59, noes, 37. Ayes 59, noes 37, the bill passes. House Bill 470 would direct the Department of Medical Assistance Services to submit state plan amendments to the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services to seek to modify the program rules for consumer-directed services available through certain Medicaid waivers.

[00:39:57] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 93, noes 3. Ayes 93, noes 3, the bill passes.

[00:40:14] Over on page 14, we continue third reading, regular House Bill 478. Now before you, relates to Diploma Seal for Excellence in Fine Arts. Established industry-recognized workforce credential. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:40:37] Ayes. 68, no's 28. Ayes, 68, no's 28. The bill passes. House Bill 483 relates to the Prescription Drug Affordability Board established. Drug Cost Affordability Review. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:41:00] Ayes. 61, no's 33. Ayes, 61, no's 33. The bill passes. House Bill 494 relates to the Virginia Personnel Act, hiring preference in state government certain former federal employees. Shall the bill pass?

[00:41:19] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 61, noes 35. Ayes 61, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 592 relates to public schools' wearable panic alarm systems.

[00:41:36] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 95, noes 1. Ayes 95, noes 1.

[00:41:51] The bill passes. House Bill, excuse me, over on page 16, we come to House Bill 670 related to labor and employment provisions, application of law, protection of employees, definition of employer. Delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Speaking to the bill. Delegate has the floor.

[00:42:07] Mr. Speaker, what better day than Valentine's Day to help out a friend? I'm looking at this bill, and I know it's not too late for it to go by for the day. Mr. Speaker, you're an attorney, I'm an attorney, there's a lot of attorneys in here, and attorneys understand the consistency under the law is important. And I just want our code to be consistent.

[00:42:24] The people of Virginia need the code to be consistent, too, because as they try to follow the laws that we pass, when you have a different meaning for something in one place than another, it's a problem. So I draw members' attention to line 39, which reads, female or woman means female 18 years of age or older.

[00:42:41] Mr. Speaker, I know that there's 64 of y'all and just 36 of us, but last year y'all had a bill where you changed the word woman to birthing individual. And so the code of Virginia now has birthing individual in it.

[00:42:52] Now, I pointed out that people in my district might not be sure what that is, but y'all apparently knew, and there's even more of you this year, so maybe you want to pull this bill for the day and change the word female or woman to the words birthing individual just so you can be consistent, or maybe you've changed on that, but I just thought on Valentine's Day I shouldn't let your error go by that I would point out that while I think that this is a pretty good definition, maybe y'all think that it should be something different based on your unanimous votes last year.

[00:43:23] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 61, noes 35.

[00:43:40] Ayes 61, noes 35. The bill passes. House Bill 832 would direct the Virginia Department of Education's Office of School and Community Nutrition Programs to provide technical assistance to the regional governing board for each academic year's governor's school relating to maximum school meal offerings.

[00:43:59] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 74, noes 22.

[00:44:15] Ayes 74, noes 22. The bill passes. House Bill 833 relates to land subdivision and development, optional provisions of a subdivision ordinance, electric vehicle charging stations, Department of Energy report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:44:38] Ayes 60, noes 34. Ayes 60, noes 34. The bill passes. House Bill 852 now before he relates to the abolition of fees, a legal representation of indigent defendant jury trial costs. Shall the bill pass?

[00:44:53] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes, 60, noes, 35. Ayes, 60, noes, 35. The bill passes.

[00:45:10] Over on page 18, we come to House Bill 955, which would require the State Council of Higher Education for Virginia to annually report certain student enrollment data. Shall the bill pass?

[00:45:33] A closer row. Ayes, 88, noes, 7. Ayes, 88, noes, 7. The bill passes. Continuing with calendar House Bill 996 before you now, I would direct the Department of Aging and Rehabilitative Services in collaboration with the Department of Education to develop a plan to expand the post-secondary education rehabilitation transition program.

[00:45:53] Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row. Ayes 90, no 6.

[00:46:10] Ayes 90, no 6. The bill passes. House Bill 1,113 would require guidance and permit policies governing the provision of culturally responsive and language-appropriate mental health support services. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[00:46:34] Ayes, 60, noes, 34. Ayes, 60, noes, 34. The bill passes. House Bill 1,208 relates to public education, early childhood care and education, child care access calculations report. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the row.

[00:46:59] Ayes 74, noes 22. Ayes 74, noes 22. The bill passes. House Bill 1278, now before you, relates to school board policies, communication and language accessibility for limited English proficient parents requirements. Shall the bill pass? Clerk will close the roll.

[00:47:24] Ayes 62, noes 33. Ayes 62, noes 33. The bill passes. And House Bill 1367, it relates to the Department of Education, English language learning students, expenditures, data collection report. Shall the bill pass?

[00:47:44] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 64, noes 31. Ayes 64, noes 31. The bill passes. Continuing with today's calendar, we now come to a new category, House Bill's on second reading, uncontested calendar.

[00:48:03] Two dozen plus bills in this uncontested second reading calendar. Top of page 21, if you're following that way. We come first to House Bill 275, which seeks to amend and reenact the Texas Code of Virginia related to employment prohibition exceptions, apprenticeships, children 16 years of age or older.

[00:48:20] This Legislation Report Committee on Labor and Commerce with Amendment Nature Substitute. Delegate from Roanoke City, Delegate Rasul. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Ladies and gentlemen, the House, House Bill 275 expands apprenticeships.

[00:48:39] The substitute is a product of stakeholders coming together. Apprenticeships for 16-year-olds and 17-year-olds who are doing well in school, or if they got second place in a statewide science fair like my daughter did yesterday. Just made that part up. I made that part up. I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to address the bill.

[00:48:55] Pass it on as third reading. Next up in the block is House Bill 413. H.P. 413 seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to the Board of Education, Board of Nursing, High School Certified Nurses Aid Training and Certification Program established. Requirements report.

[00:49:10] Legislation report committing on health and human services with an amendment. The delegate from Prince William, Delegate Guzman. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I would like to move the committee amendments. Shall the amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The amendment is agreed to. Delegate Guzman.

[00:49:26] Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 413 aims to address the shrinking certified nurse aid workforce by providing an alternative pathway to certification, allowing high school students to prepare for and obtain certification as a certified nurse aid.

[00:49:43] I hope it's the will of this body to engross this bill and pass it into its third rating. Continuing with the uncontested block, House Bill 514 seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to the Department of Veterans Services' Benefit Awareness and Access Program, Legislative Report Committee on General Laws.

[00:50:01] The delegate from Loudoun, Delegate Martinez. Thank you, Madam Speaker. H.P. 514 establishes an outreach program to ensure military service members transitioning from military to civilian life, veterans, members of the Virginia National Guard, residents of the Commonwealth and the Armed Forces Reserves, and their family members can easily access federal, state, and local benefits and other programs and services to them.

[00:50:31] Madam Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Next bill, same patron, different bill. It's House Bill 518 now. This legislation seems to amend and reenact Section of the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Consumer Protection Act, prohibited practices, streaming and advertisement volume control. This legislation reported from the Committee on General Laws, this time with amendment nature substitute.

[00:50:52] The delegate from Loudoun, Delegate Martinez. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move that the House adopt the committee's substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Delegate Martinez. Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 518 prohibits a video streaming service defined in the bill that serves consumers residing in the Commonwealth from transmitting the audio of a commercial advertisement at a louder volume than the video content that advertisement accompanies.

[00:51:28] Consistent with the regulations adopted by the Federal Communication Commission pursuant to Federal Commercial Advertisement Loudness Mitigation Act for the television, I'm sorry, it says CALM for the acronym, and for television broadcast stations, cable operators, and other multi-channel video programmer distributors.

[00:51:53] Madam Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Continuing with the block, we come now to House Bill 559, which seeks to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia related to driver training school and driver training instructors standards, discipline report, legislation reporting video on transportation.

[00:52:11] The delegate from Hanover, Delegate Wyatt. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 559 prohibits the employment of a driver training school instructor for driver education classes of minors if the instructor has been convicted of certain sex crimes or any offense that requires registration on the sex offender and crimes against minors registry.

[00:52:32] I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Next up in the uncontested block is House Bill 573. This is legislation that would direct the Board of Medicine to develop a patient decision checklist for patients considering breast implants.

[00:52:48] Legislation reporting committee on health and human services from Madam Nature Substitute. The delegate from Norfolk. Delegate Glass. Gratitude, Madam Speaker. I move the Health

Human Service Committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Delegate Glass. Gratitude, Madam Speaker.

[00:53:06] As the clerk said, the bill established a work group to create educational materials for patients considering breast implants. I move the bill be engrossed in Plaston to its third reading. House Bill 577 seeks to amend the Code of Virginia, this time relating to a social work licensure criminal background check legislation again reported committee on health and human services also with amendment nature substitute the delegate from norfolk delegate class gratitude madam speaker i move the health and human service committee substitute shall the substitute be agreed to all those in favor say aye those opposed no the substitutes agree to delegate

[00:53:41] glass gratitude madam speaker um in 2024 carried a compact for social work what this did was it brought was brought to our attention by the board of social work that the fbi needed statutory authority to receive and maintain those records confidential. And that is what this bill does. I move the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Next up in the block is House Bill 582. Different legislation to amend the Code of Virginia, this time relating to the Department of Transportation. Autonomous truck mounted attenuators pilot program authorized. This legislation report committee on transportation with amendment nature substitute. The delegate

[00:54:17] from Norfolk, Delegate Glass. Gratitude, Madam Speaker. I move the committee on transportation substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. As opposed, no. Substitute is agreed to. Gratitude, Madam Speaker. So this authorizes the Department of Transportation to establish a pilot program for implementation and deployment of autonomous truck-mounted attenuators with mobile work zones defined in the bill. This expires in January 20, 2031. I move the bill be engrossed and passed on to a third reading. Continuing with the second reading on contested counter block house bill 632 would amend the code of virginia relating to kinship foster

[00:54:57] care barrier crime waiver legislation report committee on health and human services the delegate from albermaro delegate callson thank you madam speaker house bill 632 creates a waiver process that allows local departments of social services to apply for approval when a kinship relative placement is denied solely due to state barrier crime as a reminder federal barrier crimes remain strictly non-wavable i ask that it be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. House Bill 678 it's out of the block over to the regular calendar bottom of page 24 of the printed calendar we come to House Bill 908, Legislation Amendment Reenact, Section of the Code of Virginia relating to Towing Advisory Board's membership Legislation Report Committee on Transportation

[00:55:35] with amendments. The delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you Mr. Speaker. Thank you Madam Speaker I'd move the committee amendments. Shall the amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. Those opposed no. The amendments are agreed to. Delegate Lopez. Thank you Madam Speaker. Towing Towing advisory boards were created to fairly regulate the industry with representatives from towing companies, law enforcement, and the general public.

[00:55:58] The current law, however, only requires that there be an equal number of towers and law enforcement agents as board members with just one member of the public, which often results in recommendations being submitted to county boards that raise fees and deprioritize citizens. This bill, Madam Secret, would provide a simple balancing for this system, requiring the towing advisory boards to maintain an equal number of law enforcement, towing, and public representatives.

[00:56:19] It also permits non-voting members to participate and share different perspectives to inform the conversation. Ultimately, the bill ensures that no voices will go unheard when determining wildly impactful towing policy. Madam Speaker, I move we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[00:56:35] Continue with the block. House Bill 951, before you now, seeks to amend and reenact sexual code of Virginia, this time relating to Board of Housing and Community Development ad hoc committees. Legislation reporting committee on general laws. The delegate from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Madam Speaker. The Board of Housing and Community Development often convenes an ad hoc committee to provide advice on proposals to change building and fire safety regulations, but there is currently no explicit requirement for the proposals to be brought forth in front of the full board thereafter.

[00:57:02] Because of this, many of the proposals sent to these committees never get addressed or see a vote of the full board, usually due to a mixed consensus or even just one no vote. Madam Speaker, this bill would update the statute governing the BHCD, ensuring that the Board evaluates and votes on all proposals brought forth from such committees regardless consensus, ensuring stakeholder confidence in the system, and making it more functionally effective for the safety of our communities and businesses.

[00:57:25] Madam Speaker, I move we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reason. Over on page 26, we come to House Bill 1026. It seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to foreign-trained chiropractors, licensure by endorsement. Legislative reporting committee on Health and Human Services with a substitute. The delegate from Lynchburg, Delegate Walker.

[00:57:42] Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee a substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. Substitutes agree to. Delegate Walker. Thank you, Madam Speaker. This bill helps Virginia when qualified chiropractors who are trained outside of the United States, currently even experienced chiropractors who have practiced several years in other countries, face major barriers in becoming licensed in Virginia.

[00:58:08] This bill allows the Board of Chiropractors to issue a license by endorsement to a foreign-trained chiropractor who meets several restricted requirements, including graduating with accredited institution in their country, holding a current unrestricted license with standards, and passing the same national board exam required by U.S. chiropractors.

[00:58:31] With that, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. House Bill 1043 next seeks to direct the Department of Housing and Community Development to notify applicants of awards and denials under the Affordable and Special Needs Housing program. Legislation reporting video on general laws with amendments. The delegate from Richmond City. Delegate Carr. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee amendments. Shall the amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The amendments are agreed to. Delegate Carr. Thank you, Madam Speaker. HB 1043 requires the Department of Housing and Community Development to take no longer than 75 days to renew, act on, and send their decisions

[00:59:11] to the applicants of the Affordable and Special Needs Housing Program and the Housing Trust Fund homeless reduction grant programs. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. House Bill 1047, different bills, saving patron. This one seeks to amend the Marine Act, Section Dakota, Virginia, relating to the Department of Veterans Services, Virginia War Memorial Division.

[00:59:33] Legislative support committee on general laws with an amendment of nature to substitute. The delegate from Richmond City, Delegate Carr. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee's substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed no. The sensitives agree to. Delegate Carr. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 1047 clarifies the working relationship between the Commissioner of the Division of Veterans Services and the Virginia War Memorial Foundation. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. House Bill 1060 is legislation to amend and reenact three sections of the Code of Virginia relating to foster and adoptive homes, barrier crimes, exceptions, Legislative Board Committee on Health and Human Services. The delegate from Arbor Morrow,

[01:00:13] delegate Coulson. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 1060 is cleanup legislation clarifying that the application of barrier crime exceptions applies to all adult household members who have to undergo background checks as part of the home study. I ask that it be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. House Bill 1063 is legislation to amend the code of Virginia relating to the Department of Health opioid antagonist distribution program reports. Legislation reporting committee on health and human services. The delegate from Middlesex, Delegate Hodges.

[01:00:43] Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 1063 directs the Department of Health to maintain a list of agencies and organizations that submit requests for and receive opioid antagonists through its distribution program and requires the Department to submit a quarterly report to various committees, committee chairs, and organizations.

[01:01:04] It also requires the Department to submit an annual report to the Joint Commission on Health Care. This bill is a recommendation of the Joint Commission of Health Care. I hope it will be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. Over on page 28, we come to House Bill 1120, which legislation to direct the Department of Transportation to convene a work group on improving the safety of electric power-assisted bicycles, motorized skateboards and scooters, electric personal-assisted mobility devices, and other motorized single-occupant vehicles for operators and the general public.

[01:01:36] Legislation reporting about transportation with amendments. The delegate from Loudoun. Delegate Singh. Madam Speaker I move the committee amendments. Shall the amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed no. The amendments are agreed to. Delegate Singh. Madam Speaker this legislation would create a work group to examine the panoply of laws and regulations around e-bikes and mopeds and make recommendations for safety. I move that we engross the bill and pass it on to his third reading.

[01:02:03] House Bill 1124 by Delegate Clark is legislation to amend the Code of Virginia Lane into autonomous vehicles, operation requirements, civil penalties, reports. This legislation was reported from the Committee on Transportation with an amendment nature substitute.

[01:02:22] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All in favor say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Madam Speaker. So this bill does not ban autonomous vehicles.

[01:02:38] It does not restrict innovation. Instead, it ensures that as this technology develops in Virginia, we approach it responsibly and with transparency. The substitute directs the already established work group convened by the Secretary of Transportation to formally include representatives from the

automobile manufacturing industry and labor organizations representing passenger and product carrier businesses.

[01:02:59] This work group will conduct an assessment of the labor impacts autonomous vehicles including an overview of potential job losses and job gains and report its findings no later than november 1st 2026 and i move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading continuing with the uncontested block house bill 1178 uh now before you seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the code of virginia related to authorized septic system inspectors scope of service and requirements legislation reporting on general laws with amendment to substitute the delegate from dinwiddie delegate pope adams thank you madam speaker i I move that the House adopt the committee substitute.

[01:03:31] Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. Substitutes agree to. Delegate Pope Adam. Thank you, Madam Speaker. Madam Speaker, HB 1178 brings clarity, consistency, and consumer protection to septic system inspections conducted during real estate transactions across the Commonwealth.

[01:03:51] I hope it is the will of the body to engross this bill and pass to its third reading. House Bill 1222 is legislation that seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to local departments of social services, child abuse, and neglect recorded interviews. Legislation reporting committee on health and human services.

[01:04:06] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Delaney. Thank you, Madam Speaker. House Bill 1222 requires local social service departments and all individuals witnessing or partaking in a child services interaction to record all applicable child welfare interviews.

[01:04:26] Under this bill, any party interacting with child services personnel shall record any and all communications during an investigation or family assessment. I hope it is the will of the body to engross the bill and move it to its third reading. House Bill 1270, as legislation seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia all related to transportation network companies, publishing and disclosure requirements.

[01:04:48] Legislation report committing on transportation with amendment H. Substitute. The delegate from Loudoun, Delegate Singh. Madam Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. Substitutes agree to. Delegate Singh. Madam Speaker, this bill provides more transparency to transportation network companies. I move that we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:05:08] Next up in the block, we come to House Bill 1457. Is legislation to amend and reenact multiple sections of the Code of Virginia related to vehicle weight limits violations owner of a vehicle? Legislation report committee on transportation with a substitute. The delegate from TASWELL, Delegate Moorfield.

[01:05:25] Yes, ma'am. Madam Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The substitutes agree to. Delegate Moorfield. Madam Speaker, members of the House, House Bill 1457. In the event that an overweight ticket is issued on a coal truck, this bill would clarify that the ticket be issued to the owner of the truck and not the driver of the truck.

[01:05:50] I move to engross the bill and pass it to its third greeting. Next up in the block is House Bill 1469, which is legislation to amend and reenact the Texas Code of Virginia relating to TNC Partners.

Requirements and background screening. Legislation reported the Committee on Interpretation, this time with line amendments.

[01:06:08] The delegate from Montgomery, Delegate Franklin. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move the committee amendments. Shall the amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The amendments are agreed to. Delegate Franklin. House Bill 1469 changes the requirements for background screenings of transportation network companies, so rideshare drivers have to disclose all addresses where they resided.

[01:06:31] This bill intends to keep riders safe by ensuring rideshare driver services are properly screening their drivers. I hope it is the will of the body to engross the bill and move it on to its third reading. Over on page 32, we come to the final two bills in this uncontested block.

[01:06:48] Bill before you now is House Bill 1489, which seeks to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to hospitals, reports of threats or acts of violence against health care providers, expansion of reporting requirements, legislation reported from the Committee on Health and Human Services. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Tran.

[01:07:04] Thank you so much, Madam Speaker. This bill requires hospitals with an emergency department to collect data on workplace violence incidents, report it to the Virginia Department of Health, and will then post it in aggregate form. I move that the body engrossed the bill and pass it on to its third reading.

[01:07:20] And the last bill in this category in the block is House Bill 1495. This legislation would direct the Department of Medical Services to seek the necessary permission from the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services to oversee the activities of Medicaid enrolled service facilitators. Again, reported from the Committee on Health and Human Services, it's time with amendment of nature substitute.

[01:07:39] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Tran. Thank you, Madam Speaker. I move that the House adopt the committee substitute. Shall the substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. Those opposed, no. Substitutes agree to. Delegate Tran. Madam Speaker, this bill brings services facilitation under the statewide fiscal employer agent contract and requires DMAS to develop a formal monitoring and oversight plan.

[01:08:00] Hope it's the well of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bills be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bills are engrossed and passed the third reading. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, we come to a new category. House bills on second reading regular, approximately 20-plus bills in this category.

[01:08:17] Top of page 33, if you're following that way, House Bill 524 is by for the day. So therefore, the first bill in this new category is House Bill 797. House Bill 797 is legislation to amend the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Information Technologies Agency, Artificial Intelligence, Independent Verification Organizations.

[01:08:40] Legislation report committee on communications technology innovation with a substitute. Subsequently, it was reported to the committee on appropriations with a different substitute. Delicate from Chesapeake. Delicate Hayes. Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. I move to committee substitute. Which one? Of the appropriations committee.

[01:08:57] What are you going to do with the first one? Accept that one as well. Oh, no, strike that. See, we have these words here that are important in how we communicate, so all people want to understand. So what would you like to do with the CTI committee substitute?

[01:09:14] Reject the CTI substitute and accept the appropriations. How long have you been here? Anyway, shall the CTI committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye.

[01:09:30] All those opposed, no. No. CTI Committee substitute is not agreed to. The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 797. You want to move the Appropriations Committee substitute now? Yes, sir, Mr. Speaker. I move that we accept the Appropriations Committee substitute.

[01:09:49] Those words. Shall the Committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Those opposed, no. The Committee substitute is agreed to. The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you so much. House Bill 797 directs the Information Technology Agency of Virginia and authorize and oversee a marketplace of independent verification organizations for artificial intelligence products.

[01:10:11] These expert-led third-party bodies verify that AI systems meet heightened safety and risk prevention standards. The participation is voluntary, but companies will receive a gold standard seal. I ask that we engross the bill and move it on to its third reading.

[01:10:30] Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. Over on page 34, we come to House Bill 55. Legislation to amend and reenact sections of the Code of Virginia relating to noise abatement monitoring systems, local authority, civil penalties. Legislation reporting on transportation with amendment nature substitute.

[01:10:49] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Sullivan. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. the committee substitutes agree to thank you mr speaker hb 55 creates a two-year pilot program in planning districts 8 9 15 and 16 authorizing noise abatement monitoring systems to aid local law enforcement in identifying and finding loud vehicles with illegally modified mufflers i hope it'll be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading all those in favor say aye all those opposed no the bill's engrossed and passed the third read next we come to house bill uh 122 which seeks to amend

[01:11:27] and reenact various portions of the code of Virginia all related to manufacture or sale of cosmetic products containing certain ingredients prohibited. Legislation was reported committee on general laws with amendment nature substitute and Ms. Speaker the bill's patron has floor amendments drawn to that substitute. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Keyes Gamara. Yes Mr. Speaker I move the substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye.

[01:11:51] All those opposed no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Mr. Speaker I also move I believe there's an amendment to this? Clerk will report the floor. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, floor amendments are offered by Delegate Keyes-Gamara. The amendments are available online on IHOD here for the members and on LIS, Legislative Information System for the public. So those amendments are distributed and now before you. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Keyes-Gamara.

[01:12:18] All right, speaking to the bill, Mr. Speaker. Would you like to move the floor amendments and tell us what they do? Yes, I'm sorry. What do they do and then move them? The line amendment simply makes sure that we We don't have any conflicting language with the FDA. So I'm moving that amendment, that line amendment.

[01:12:35] Shall the floor amendments be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The floor amendments are agreed to. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Keyes-Gabon. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. First, speaking to the bill, I'd like to thank Delegate Cousins for all of her hard work on this bill. And moving forward, House Bill 122 aims to regulate the safety of cosmetics.

[01:12:55] There are 12 toxic ingredients listed in this bill. And these ingredients have been scientifically confirmed to pose a significant threat to public health and safety as they are carcinogens or have been linked to reproductive and immune system problems.

[01:13:11] With that, I move that this bill be engrossed and passed on to the third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 283, now before you, seeks to amend and reenact a section of the Code of Virginia relating to child abuse or neglect.

[01:13:32] prenatal use of controlled substance or drug as prescribed. Legislation report committing on health and human services with a line amendment. Delegate from Chesterfield, Delegate Gordon. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. First, I'd like to move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no.

[01:13:48] The committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. In the Commonwealth of Virginia, women who are pregnant and in recovery for opioid addiction face an impossible decision. This is driven by ambiguity in the state law that essentially treats any woman who is prescribed medication for opioid use disorder, such as methadone or burenorphine, I never get that word right, sorry, while pregnant, as engaged in abuse under neglect of their unborn child.

[01:14:19] As a result, these women must choose whether to discontinue their prescribed medication and run the high risk of addiction relapse and overdose or face the prospect of having their lives turned upside down and their child potentially taken away from them because they continue to take their prescribed medication.

[01:14:42] House Bill 283 removes the ambiguity from the state law by making it clear that if a pregnant woman is taking prescribed medication under the care of her physician, that she is not engaged in child abuse or neglect solely for taking that controlled substance as prescribed.

[01:15:03] This bill codifies Virginia Department of Services' existing practices. Mr. Speaker, I move that this bill be engrossed and passed this third reading. Shall the bill be engrossing past the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossing past the third reading.

[01:15:20] We're on page 35. We come to House Bill 375. This is legislation to amend and reenact multiple portions of the Code of Virginia, all relating to Manufacturing Home Lot Rental Act, right of first refusal, resident entities, and localities. Legislation report committee on general laws with amendment a substitute.

[01:15:36] Doug from Fairfax. Delegate Cresick. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor, say aye. Aye. Others oppose no? Committee substitutes the degree to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Members of the body, House Bill 375 strengthens protections for residents of manufactured home communities, especially when those communities are sold or closed, while still preserving the park owner's ability to sell their property.

[01:16:00] You all know that manufactured homes are really one of our most affordable forms of homeownership, but in recent years we've seen many of these parks sold to investors who either raise lot rents to unaffordable levels or close the park completely to redevelop the land into something more valuable for them.

[01:16:18] This bill will provide a right of first refusal to the park residents who own their homes and rent lots in the park, as well as to the locality in which the park sits as a way for us to maintain these affordable communities for Virginians. I hope it's the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading. The delegate from Campbell, Delegate Zier.

[01:16:35] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Would the patron yield for a question? Would the delegate yield? I yield. Delegate will yield. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I'm wondering if there's a provision in here which would allow the family members of the park owners to purchase this property below market value or at a price less than they could otherwise get.

[01:16:53] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Creasy. Mr. Speaker, could you please repeat the question? I asked the delegate to repeat the question. I could not hear it. No problem. I'm wondering if there's a provision in this bill which would allow family members to purchase the property at a price below market value.

[01:17:14] The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Creason. Mr. Speaker, I would say to the delegate that this bill just deals with the, gives the park the ability, the residents of the park to buy the park. So if it was sold for less than value, whatever the value might be, the park residents would be able to match that value.

[01:17:37] So they could, what they have to do is they'd have to create a group, 51% of the park residents would have to create this tenant or park resident group, and they would have the opportunity to match whatever that price is.

[01:17:55] Speaking to the bill. Doug, it has the floor. Mr. Speaker, my elderly friends, Larry and Donna, recently moved into a mobile home park. They chose the Oaks because the owner of the park lives there on site. Through the years as they've aged, their son has stepped up.

[01:18:12] He's been out in the middle of the night removing limbs from the road. He's been in the ditch fixing plumbing, swatting gnats in the heat. He's been fixing roads. This has gone on for years. Donna and Larry chose that mobile home park because the family lives there. And I'm concerned we're going to be turning these family-owned parks that are chosen specifically because the family owns them.

[01:18:34] We're removing that for people like Larry and Donna. Thank you. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bell. I think that if your concern is living in a mobile home park where the owners are also the residents, you'd love this bill.

[01:18:49] This bill doesn't allow any below-market purchases. This is a right of first refusal. That means you put it on the market, the market establishes the price, and then you have one class of owners that has

the first option to buy it at that market rate. So it doesn't do anything to diminish the value of the park for the owners and for those good folks who have been taking care of it, but it means sure they get at least market value.

[01:19:09] But it gives the people who live in the park the opportunity to pull their resources together and buy that park and maintain it as what it is, which is an affordable place to live. It's some of our most affordable housing stock. And when we talk about affordability, this is one of the most important affordability housing bills that we have this session.

[01:19:25] I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it towards third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Next up is House Bill 379. This legislation seeks to amend and reenact portions of the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act, application, notice, deposit, fee, and additional information.

[01:19:44] Legislation report being on general laws, again, with Madam Nature Substitute. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Benny Parker. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 379 brings more transparency and fairness to the rental application process by requiring disclosure of fees and eligibility criteria, helping applicants identify and correct errors in screening reports and capping application fees at actual cost incurred.

[01:20:10] The bill will make the process of finding housing smoother and more affordable for our constituents. I move the bill be engrossed and advanced to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 636 now before you seeks to amend the Code of Virginia relating to prohibiting employer seeking wage or salary history of prospective employees, wage or salary range transparency, cost of action.

[01:20:35] Legislation reporting committee on labor and commerce with the amendment of nature substitute. From Prince William, Delegate Maldonado. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I thank the clerk for reading such a great and comprehensive description. The only thing I would add is that we did have a substitute, and I'd like to move that substitute and then speak to it.

[01:20:54] Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. The substitute is a compromise that we reached working with the Virginia Chamber of Commerce. This bill, unlike the previous times it has come to this floor, now includes a provision with a 15 business day right to cure.

[01:21:13] I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to its third reading. House Bill 652 is legislation to amend and reenact a section of the Code of Virginia relating to abused or neglected child prenatal substance abuse.

[01:21:29] This legislation will support the Committee on Health and Human Services with an amendment nature of substitute. Just one. The delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Yes, sir, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no, the committee substitute is agreed to.

[01:21:47] Delegate from Chesapeake, Delegate Hayes. Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, the substitute creates a work group to move us towards a more supportive rather than punitive model around prenatal and postnatal substance use. I hope it's the will of the body to engross the bill and moving on to its third reading.

[01:22:05] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Substitute is agreed to. I mean, the bill is grosser passes the third reading. Page 36, we come to House Bill 656. It says legislation to amend and reenact multiple sections of the Code of Virginia related to mental health and substance abuse disorders, network adequacy standards, comparative analyses, report emergency regulations.

[01:22:29] The Legislation report a committee on health and human services with a substitute. That's from Henrico, Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee substitutes agree to the delegate from Henrico, Delegate Willett. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 656, the substitute, strengthens mental health parity in Virginia by ensuring mental health and substance use disorder care is covered and accessible in the same insurance terms as medical and surgical care.

[01:22:54] I hope it would be the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. On page 37, we come to House Bill 925. Legislation amended and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Human Rights Act, unlawful discriminatory practices, civil actions, statute of limitations.

[01:23:16] Legislation report, committee on labor and commerce. Then from Arlington, Delegate Lopez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Workers are often unaware of their rights in the face of discriminatory practices. The Virginia Human Rights Act arbitrarily stricts 300-day complaint filing limit and civil action restrictions contribute significantly to this, not aligning with similar statutes and often resulting in no action being taken at all.

[01:23:38] Mr. Speaker, this bill will extend the Office of Civil Rights in the AG's office complaint period to two years after an alleged discriminatory violation to align the time frame with other tort law and VHRA statutes. It will also allow aggrieved persons to file a civil action within 180 days of filing a complaint with a local Human Rights Commission rather than exclusively with the AG's Office of Civil Rights or the Equal Employment Opportunity Commission.

[01:24:01] Mr. Speaker, this bill would make sure that all Virginians suffering from discriminatory practices have sufficient time and access to use the laws that are meant to protect them. Mr. Speaker, I move that we engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. Those engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:24:16] House Bill 930 now before you seeks to amend and reenact. Section Dakota, Virginia, relating to protection of employees, retaliatory action prohibited. Legislation report committee on labor and commerce with amendment nature substitute. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Simon. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, House Bill 930 expands on a whistleblower protection law that we passed about five years ago in 2021.

[01:24:37] It strengthens and expands the existing law by adding clear, explicit language which will allow employees to come forward in good faith to report unlawful actions, expands who they can report the unlawful actions to, prohibits some workarounds that employers have come up with in the last five years by embedding some of these waivers of their whistleblower protections in their handbooks, employee handbooks, and permits the, remove the committee substitute. Oh, shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye.

[01:25:03] All those opposed, no. The committee substitute is agreed to. This is my parliamentarian. But go ahead. Let me see that book. Hold on. Give him that book. Mr. Speaker, as I was saying, the substitute does all those things and more and gives the Attorney General the opportunity to bring forth civil action to help enforce rights under the Code. I hope it would be the pleasure of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. The delegate from Patrick County, Delegate Williams. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I'd ask the...

[01:25:33] Will the delegate yield for a question? Yes. I'm trying to help y'all with these words. Y'all, it's Friday, y'all tired. It's Friday, Mr. Speaker. I'm just going to make the motions for y'all from now on, okay? It's Friday. Will the delegate yield for a question? Mr. Speaker, I'll yield. The delegate will yield. I'd ask the patron, would his bill protect a worker who calls ICE to report that their union boss is hiring illegal immigrants?

[01:25:56] Mr. Speaker, I would say to the delegate that this bill is meant to help improve on the employer protections we provided in 2001. and protect those employees who report illegal activity by their employer. Delegate from Patrick County, Delegate Williams.

[01:26:11] I don't even know what the answer was, so I'm just going to sit down. That was the idea. Should the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:26:28] House Bill 936 is by for the day. Therefore, next bill, second reading calendar, category, page 38. We come to House Bill 970. which is legislation to amend and reenact to Section Dakota, Virginia, relating to preventative dental assistance licensing.

[01:26:44] Legislation report a committee on health and human services with a substitute. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I would like to move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no.

[01:26:59] The committee substitute is agreed to. The bar has just dropped so low now. I'm going to raise it. We just keep it. Like, yeah, somebody finally got the committee substitute correct. Okay. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, thank you, Mr. Speaker. Many know that I worked for 10 years in dental office management, most of which were with my favorite general dentist.

[01:27:19] During that time, I loved helping patients get the care they needed. Unfortunately, we are hearing that patients are unable to get what they need, as many across the Commonwealth are having trouble scheduling appointments for their regular dental cleanings. It is well known that our dental health impacts the rest of our body in important ways.

[01:27:36] This is especially true for those who have diabetes, heart disease, are pregnant, or have braces. We have expanded Medicaid to cover some dental services, but patients cannot find appointments. At the same time, a school that hosts a dental hygiene educational program is experiencing issues further complicating the workforce shortage.

[01:27:54] So stakeholders came together to find creative ways to address this shortage. House Bill 970 would help by allowing dental assistants with 1,800 hours or more of clinical experience to obtain training and certification to assist with basic functions during dental hygiene appointments under the supervision of a licensed dentist or a licensed dental hygienist.

[01:28:17] This is supported by the Virginia Dental Association, the free clinics, and the community colleges. I hope that we would engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossing past the third reading. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, we now come to House Bill 1036, which is legislation to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to dental hygienist licensure.

[01:28:44] Dentists eligible to practice in a foreign country or jurisdiction. This legislation is reported to be on health and human services with an amendment. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Tran. Thank you so much, Mr. Speaker. I'd like to move the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to.

[01:29:00] Thank you. Mr. Speaker, this bill allows the Board of Dentistry to consider dental hygienist licensure applications from foreign trained dentists who have met the following criteria, that they've graduated from dental school outside of the United States, they were or are eligible to practice dentistry abroad, that they demonstrate good moral character, and that they pass the dental hygiene examination given by the Joint Commission on National Dental Examinations, and that they successfully complete a clinical examination exam.

[01:29:31] to the board. I hope it's the will of the body to engross this bill and pass it on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 1065 now before you seeks to amend the code of Virginia related to electric utilities surplus interconnection service sites. This legislation reported on labor and commerce with an amendment of nature substitute. Delegate from Norfolk, Hernandez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye.

[01:30:02] All those opposed no, the committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. HB 1065 aims to help Virginia add more power to the grid quickly by maximizing the energy infrastructure we already have. The bill requires both Dominion and APCO to undertake a comprehensive assessment of surplus interconnection capacity at their existing and planned solar generation facilities.

[01:30:22] The bill also establishes pilot programs of up to 500 megawatts for Dominion, 100 megawatts for APCO of solar and energy storage resources that utilize surplus interconnection and lower costs for families. I move that we engross the bill and pass it along to a third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading?

[01:30:39] All those in favor say aye. Aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Ms. Speaker, members of the House, continuing, we come now to House Bill 1319, which is legislation to amend and reenact two sections of the Code of Virginia relating to unemployment benefits, maximum duration.

[01:31:04] This legislation is reported to be on labor and commerce. That's from Law, Delegate Martinez. Thank you, Mr. Speaker, and I really am feeling the love today, and I do not have a committee substitute to move. However, HB 1319 comes from a recommendation from the National Employment Law Project.

[01:31:21] This bill sets the maximum potential benefit duration for unemployment insurance at a uniform 26 weeks for all claimants, getting rid of the current range of 12 to 26 weeks. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading.

[01:31:38] Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Rockham, Delegate Will, would you like to speak to the bill? I wonder if the patient would, or patient. He might be right. You might be right. The delegate, would the delegate yield for a question?

[01:31:56] Mr. Speaker, I would yield for a question. The delegate would yield. Mr. Speaker, I would ask the patron, I'm asking for a friend, but could he tell us where he got that jacket? Mr. Speaker, I'll answer the delegate that it's a secret because I do not want anybody to copy me.

[01:32:22] Mr. Clerk, please take over. Did we take that one out? Continuing with the calendar, House Bill 1360, which seeks to establish a policy of the Commonwealth regarding investor-owned electric utilities and to direct the State Corporation Commission to investigate certain utility practices.

[01:32:51] Legislature for a committee on labor and commerce with amendment nature substitute. The delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Shin. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move adoption of the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. Aye.

[01:33:06] All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. You know this is going to be used in a campaign ad against you, but go ahead. Well, Mr. Speaker, they're about to use this in the campaign ad, too, because I've got a poem for you on this Valentine's Day. Roses are red, violets are blue, affordability is for me and for you.

[01:33:27] And that's the theme of this bill, Mr. Speaker. House Bill 1360 addresses the practice of uneconomic dispatch, which is when electric utility companies deploy self-scheduled generation at a cost greater than what is available for purchase on the market, and thus charging rate payers more than is necessary.

[01:33:45] So House Bill 1360 will require investor-owned utilities to disclose information about must-run decisions in their annual fuel factor proceedings and direct the SEC to determine whether these must-run decisions were reasonable and prudent. If the SEC should find a decision to be unreasonable, it will deny recovery of those costs and save ratepayers' money.

[01:34:05] Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading after there was a substitute. I thought we just moved a substitute. We did. The delegate from Buckingham, Delegate Garrett. Mr. Speaker, would the patron yield for a question? Would the patron yield for a question?

[01:34:20] Yes, Mr. Speaker, I yield. Mr. Speaker, I heard the patron talking about affordability. I just wanted to ask, is this Valentine's Day or April Fool's? Mr. Speaker, today is Valentine's Day in spite of the foolery that he might be familiar with. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading?

[01:34:38] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed know the bill that engrossed and passed the third reading. Geesh, people. House Bill 1405 is legislation to amend the Code of Virginia related to local

departments of social services burial assistance program. Legislative supporting committee on health and human services from M&H substitute.

[01:34:54] Delegate from Arlington, Delegate McClure. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House adopt the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to all those in favor say aye. Although the opposed, no, the committee's substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 1405, as amended, would provide the Department of Social Services to establish a burial assistance program and begin issuing regulations so that local departments may pay reasonable funeral expenses for a deceased person who either received public assistance or was a Virginia resident receiving supplemental security income.

[01:35:23] This program would be similar to a previous policy we had here once in the Commonwealth, the General Relief Burial Program, which provided individuals with assistance for burial-related expenses. Mr. Speaker, I move that the bill be engrossed and passed on to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye.

[01:35:38] All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. Over on page 40, we come to House Bill 1481. House Bill 1481 is legislation that seeks to amend the Code of Virginia related to labor and employment notification of federal and state statute of limitations. This legislation report is depending on labor and commerce.

[01:35:55] Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate Keyes-Gamara. Yes, Mr. Speaker, speaking to the bill. The delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, House Bill 1481 allows employers to inform their employees when there has been an alleged act of discrimination to make sure that they do not lose an opportunity to complain properly.

[01:36:16] I move that this bill be engrossed and passed to this third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to this third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed on this third reading. House Bill 1487, legislation to amend and reenact two sections go to Virginia relating to pilot program for underground transmission lines, qualifying projects, levy report.

[01:36:36] Legislation reporting committee on labor and commerce with an amendment in the nature of the substitute. From Loughton, Delegate Singh. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the substitute. The committee's substitute be agreed to. All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee's substitute is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, this bill creates a pilot program to bury underground 500 kilovolt power lines.

[01:36:55] I move that we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reader. Delegate from Falk here, Delegate Weber. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, will the patron yield for a couple of questions? Will the delegate yield for a couple of questions? The delegate commits to yielding to one question, and we'll see from there. Delegate will yield.

[01:37:12] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, so while the description of the bill was that it creates a pilot program to bury the 500 KV lines, I guess my question is, at least as I saw it coming through committee, in order to pay for those, a locality may, I guess, pay for half of the burial of that particular project, and the locality would then recover those costs through a utility tax.

[01:37:48] It also removes the cap that was on the previous project. Does that not expose the taxpayers and the ratepayers to some unaffordable costs? Delegate from Loudoun County.

[01:38:05] Mr. Speaker, responding to the delegate, this bill creates a multi-tiered process. First, the locality has to approve through resolution that it wants to proceed. And if it does proceed, it has three options for contributing its share to the program. One would be a general obligation bond, three would be general revenues, and three would be through a levy on customers.

[01:38:26] Delegate from Farquhar, Delegate Weber. Would the gentleman yield for one final question? For the delegate yield. The delegate will yield. Has there been an example either in the Commonwealth of Virginia or across the country where we have buried 500 KV lines, and what was the approximate cost of that project?

[01:38:46] Delegate from Lapp. Mr. Speaker, I would say that this happened in Chino Hills, California, first of all, and second of all, this bill is about innovation. If the SEC determines that it's not the interest of the public, the project will not proceed. I thank the delegate. Shall the bill be engrossing past the third reading?

[01:39:01] All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill's engrossing past the third reading. House Bill 1491, different bill. This one seeks to amend and reenact the Portion of Dakota, Virginia, relating to electric utilities, construction of certain electrical transmission lines, citing requirements.

[01:39:16] This legislation likewise reports a committee on labor and commerce with an amendment, nature substitute. Then from Loudoun County, Delegate Singh. Mr. Speaker, I move the substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The substitute is agreed to. Mr. Speaker, we have a significant power problem. According to a JLARC study, our power needs in the Commonwealth are expected to double over the next 10 years.

[01:39:37] This means more substations and more transmission lines. In particular, Mr. Chairman, Mr. Speaker, excuse me, we have 500 kilovolt power lines coming through Loudoun Valley Estates 1, 2, and 3 in my district. But this problem is coming for all of us. So it's time we give the SEC some direction on where transmission lines ought to go.

[01:39:58] At present, Phase II utilities have to condemn properties when a transmission line comes within 60 feet of a dwelling or other structure. This bill does two things. First, it instructs the SEC to determine the proposed transmission line will reasonably avoid homes and other elements.

[01:40:16] Second, it instructs the SEC to prioritize routes that are at least 150 feet away from a house, school, daycare, or house of worship unless no other alternative exists. Mr. Speaker, I move that we engross the bill and pass it on to its third reading. Delegate from Fall Care, Delegate Weber, you have another question?

[01:40:33] You good? Okay. Shall the bill be engrossed and pass the third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading. House Bill 1522, now before you, seeks to amend and reenact two sections. Go to Virginia relating to nursing homes and assisted living facilities.

[01:40:50] Licensure, automated external defibrillators. Legislation report committee on health and human services with an amendment. Delegate from Fairfax, Delegate McGuire. Mr. Speaker, I'd like to move the committee amendment. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker.

[01:41:06] Mr. Speaker, HB 1522 requires all licensed nursing homes and assisted living facilities to have an automated external defibrillator, an AED, on site and to have staff trained on its use. It does have a delayed enactment date to allow for time to come into compliance with this new requirement. I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading.

[01:41:24] Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossing past the third reading. House Bill 1523 is different legislation. This seeks to amend the Code of Virginia related to Certified Violence Prevention Professionals Certification. Legislation report committee on health and human services with amendments.

[01:41:41] Senator from Fairfax, Senator McGuire. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee amendments. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The committee amendment is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, HB 1523 asks VDH to create a licensure for community violence prevention professionals.

[01:41:58] This new license would ensure standardization and training and expertise for professionals doing the work in the field to keep our community safe. I hope it is the will of the body to engross the bill and pass it to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed the third reading? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed the third reading.

[01:42:14] And the last bill on this second reading, regular, going back to page 24, we pick up House Bill 678, which is legislation to amend and reenact a section of the code of Virginia relating to the Virginia Residential Landlord and Tenant Act, terms and conditions of rental agreement, notice of rent increase. Legislation reporting committee on general laws with the amendment of nature substitute.

[01:42:32] Delegate from Prince William, Delegate Maldonado. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, I move the committee substitute. Shall the committee substitute be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee substitute is agreed to. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Mr. Speaker, this bill, HB 678, helps to clarify a little loophole that was present in a bill that I passed a year or two ago.

[01:42:55] And that was a bill that required landlords to provide 60 days advance notice if they were going to increase the rent. However, what was happening is that landlords were giving that notice and demanding response immediately. The entire point is to give tenants enough time to figure out the best solution for themselves and their families regarding housing.

[01:43:16] This bill, with the substitute, clarifies now that that notice has to be given of any increase 90 days ahead of time, and any response required cannot be made a requirement prior to 30 days following that 90-day notice.

[01:43:31] I move that the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading. Shall the bill be engrossed and passed to its third reading? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. The bill is engrossed and passed to third reading. House will be at ease.

[01:47:18] The House will come to order.

[01:50:56] Ms. Clerk. Mr. Speaker, members of the House, we have a new category, resolutions. regular calendar page 42 of the printed calendar there are six resolutions in this so we begin top of page 42 the first one is senate joint resolution 69 confirming appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the general assembly october 1st 2025 the legislation resolution was reported to the

committee on privileges and elections with amendments and the chairman of p&e delegate price has floor amendments those floor amendments are available to the members online, to the public through LIS, and that's where we are.

[01:51:33] Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, thank you, Mr. Speaker. I move the committee amendments and ask that we would adopt them. Shall the committee amendment? Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. Mr. Speaker, I would move that we sever the committee amendments and vote in a block so we can vote no on those committee amendments.

[01:51:58] Okay. He would like us to name it. I understand. The committee amendments are already in the block, so would you like ayes and nays? I'm going to help you all out. Okay. Shall the commitment be agreed to?

[01:52:13] Ayes and nays. Put it on the board. All right. We just put it on the board. Clerk, we'll close the roll.

[01:52:33] Ayes 61, Nose 33 on the committee amendments. The committee amendments are agreed to. The delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes. Still on Senate Joint Resolution 69, I would like to move the floor amendments and ask that we vote yes.

[01:52:48] Shall the floor amendments be agreed to? And I call for the ayes and nays. Thank you. Ayes and nays, Madam Clerk. Ayes and nays, Madam Clerk. Shall the floor amendments be agreed to?

[01:53:13] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 62, noes 32. Floor amendments agreed to. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, I now move that we would adopt Senate Joint Resolution 69 as amended.

[01:53:31] Mr. Speaker. Delegate from Scott County, Delegate Kibble. I would encourage you to vote for... Mr. Speaker, I think having voted on the prevailing side by which we adopted those floor amendments, you guys have somebody who wants to change their vote. You weren't on the prevailing side. Do you want to reconsider it? No?

[01:53:47] No. Mr. Can you stop doing that job? You didn't do your job right. Leave that job alone. They're looking from Scott County, Delegate Kilgore. I did not vote on the – the gentleman is correct. I did not vote on the prevailing side on that.

[01:54:04] What are you trying to get done, sir? Do you want to do a re-vote? Someone missed a vote. Someone missed a vote over here. All right, somebody. Mr. Speaker, Mr. Speaker, I withdraw that. They have left.

[01:54:20] Sorry. Shall the resolution be agreed to? Shall the resolution be agreed to? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:54:41] Mr. Speaker, ayes 93, noes 0. Ayes 93, noes 0, the resolution is agreed to. We've got to do this a couple more times, so don't screw it up. Delegate, Mr. Clerk. Mr. Speaker, page 43, new resolution. Now we come to Senate Joint Resolution 70.

[01:54:58] S.J.R. 70 would confirm appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the General Assembly August 13th, 2025. Legislation reported committing on privileges and elections with amendments, and the chairman chair has floor amendments as well.

[01:55:15] Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I am going to move the committee amendments, and I ask for everyone in the room to not say yes, but to say no. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye.

[01:55:31] Those opposed, no. No. Committee amendment is rejected. No. The delegate from Newport News. Thank you. Now on Senate Joint Resolution 70, I would move that we would adopt the floor amendments and that my side vote yes.

[01:55:55] Ayes and nays. Ayes and nays. Madam Clerk, ayes and nays. Shall the floor amendment be agreed to? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:56:14] Ayes, 61, noes, 33. Ayes, 61, noes, 33. The floor amend is agreed to. The delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, thank you, Mr. Speaker. I now move that we would adopt Senate Joint Resolution 70. Shall the resolution be agreed to?

[01:56:42] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 93, noes 0, abstentions 1. Ayes 93, noes 0, abstentions 1. The resolution is agreed to. Right, continuing with the resolution's regular calendar. Now we come to page 45 of the printed calendar.

[01:56:59] We come to Senate Joint Resolution 71. Confirming appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the General Assembly On January 12, 2026, this legislation likewise was reported to the committee, privileged elections with amendments, and the chair, Delegate Price, has floor amendments as well.

[01:57:15] Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would move the committee amendments and ask that we reject them by not saying yes and only saying no. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor say aye. All those opposed, no. Committee amendment is rejected. The delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price.

[01:57:31] Thank you. I now would move that we would adopt the floor amendments for Senate Joint Resolution 71, and I call for the ayes and nays. Ayes and nays. Shall the floor amendments be agreed to? Madam Clerk, clerk will close the roll.

[01:57:56] Ayes 61, noes 33. Ayes 61, noes 33, the floor amendments are agreed to. The delegate from Newport News, delegate press. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I now would move that we would adopt Senate Joint Resolution 71. Shall the resolution be agreed to? Clerk will close the roll.

[01:58:20] Ayes 94, noes 0. House 94, no, zero. The resolution is agreed to. Now we come to Senate Joint Resolution 72. This is confirming appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the General Assembly on May 30, 2025. This legislation, again, reports committee on privileges and elections with amendments, and the chair of P&E also has floor amendments.

[01:58:41] Derek from Newport News, Delegate Price. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I am going to move the committee amendments, and I would ask that we would reject them by not saying yes and only saying no. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? All those in favor, say aye. All those opposed, no. No. The committee amendment is rejected. You told them and they still did it, but that's okay.

[01:59:01] The delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would now like to move to adopt the floor amendments, and I call for the ayes and nays. Ayes and nays, ayes and nays, okay. Madam Clerk, open the roll. Shall the floor amendment be agreed to? Clerk, close the roll.

[01:59:25] Ayes. 61, no's 33. Ayes 61, noes 33. The floor amendment is agreed to. The delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I now move that we would adopt Senate Joint Resolution 72. Shall the resolution be agreed to? Close the roll.

[01:59:46] Ayes 93, noes 0. Ayes 93, noes 0. The resolution is agreed to. Over on page 46 of the printed calendar, resolution is regular. We come to Senate Joint Resolution 73, confirming appointments by the governor of a certain person who's communicated to the General Assembly on December 1, 2025.

[02:00:02] Legislation reporting on privileges of the election with amendments, and the chair, Delegate Price, has floor amendments here as well. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would move the committee amendments and call for the ayes and nays and ask that we would support the amendments. Madam Clerk, shall the committee amendment be agreed to?

[02:00:26] Clerk will close the row. Ayes 61, noes 32. Ayes 61, noes 32. The committee amendment is agreed to. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price.

[02:00:43] Yes. I would also now like to adopt the floor amendments, move that we adopt the floor amendments, and I call for the ayes and nays. Ayes and nays. Okay. Shall the floor amendment be agreed to? Madam Clerk, close the roll.

[02:01:07] Ayes. 61, noes. 32. Ayes. 61, noes. 32. The floor amendments are agreed to. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I now move that we would adopt Senate Joint Resolution 73. Shall the resolution be agreed to? Clerk will close the roll.

[02:01:29] Ayes. 93, noes. 0. Ayes. 93, noes. 0. The resolution is agreed to. And over on page 47, we come to Senate Joint Resolution 74. Forming appointments by the governor of certain persons communicated to the General Assembly January 16, 2026.

[02:01:45] Legislation report building on privileged elections with amendments. There are no, and just the floor amendments are before you. I'm sorry, the committee amendment, I apologize. Yes, the committee amendments from P&E are before you, but there are no floor amendments. Delegate Price.

[02:02:01] Yes, thank you, Mr. Speaker. I would move that we would adopt the committee amendments, and I call for the ayes and nays. Ayes and nays. Shall the committee amendment be agreed to? Madam Clerk, clerk will close the roll.

[02:02:21] Ayes 61, noes 32. Ayes 61, noes 32. The committee amendment is agreed to. Delegate from Newport News, Delegate Price. Yes, Mr. Speaker, I now move that we would adopt Senate Joint Resolution 74. Shall the resolution be agreed to?

[02:02:41] Clerk will close the roll. Ayes 93, noes 0. Ayes 93, noes 0. committee the resolution is agreed to all right miss figure members house that completes that category memorial resolutions category and the committing resolutions we have already dispensed with both of those earlier during the morning hour so that completes today's per house rule 51 the house of turn to the morning hour does the clerk have any additional announcements on communication

[02:03:15] no communications just the announcements for this afternoon as we prepare for a crossover on Tuesday. So the Committee for Courts of Justice is meeting 15 minutes after. We're going to, Courts of Justice will meet immediately upon adjournment in the House, approximately 1:30 over in House Committee Room C on the second floor. Then the Committee on Appropriations is meeting 15

immediately. They're going to meet immediately as well. So there are seven subcommittees of the House Appropriations Committee that will be meeting, and then the full committee all up on

[02:03:54] 12th floor so immediately upon adjourn the house we will have appropriations higher education subcommittee first then it will be the elementary and secondary subcommittee of approbs once they're finished then the comp and retire compensation retirement subcommittee will meet of appropriations once they're finished then transportation and public safety subcommittee will meet then commerce and agriculture natural resources subcommittee will meet then the general government and capital outlay subcommittee will meet and then the health and human resources subcommittee appropriations. So seven subcommittees appropriations all up on the 12th floor. And then once the seven subcommittees are finished, then the full appropriations committee will take up its docket

[02:04:33] and work its will. That is the only announcement or only meetings of those two, courts and appropes, that are meeting this afternoon. The majority leader is going to talk about the need for a pro forma uh session on uh sunday which she can explain uh and then on monday um we will not have any legislative business it'll just be uh the caucus meetings um since we're going in um early uh or on um monday that the democratic caucus will be meeting at 9 15 on uh monday in house room uh

[02:05:10] Room 1 and the Republican caucus will be meeting at 8.30 a.m. They'll be in House Room 2. So that's all the announcements I have. Delegate from Alexandria, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that when the House adjourns today, it adjourned to reconvene Sunday at 1 p.m.

[02:05:27] and speaking to that motion, Mr. Speaker. Delegate has the floor. Mr. Speaker, thank you so much. Just members know that on Sunday is a pro forma session, so not everyone needs to be here. Your leadership will tell you if you need to be there, and we have done the same on this side.

[02:05:44] So just a few members need to be there. We are coming in on Sunday to advance the calendar so that all of our bills are on second read and so that we'll be ready to get everything passed by Tuesday as required by our resolution that we pass, that we agree to get our business done.

[02:06:00] Thank you, Mr. Speaker. Delicate from Alexandria. Delicate Heron moves up in the House to adjourn today to adjourn to reconvene Sunday at 1 p.m. As many in favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to the Delegate from Alexander, Delegate Herring. Mr. Speaker, I move that the House do now adjourn. Delegate from Alexander moves that the House do now adjourn.

[02:06:16] As many as favor, the motion will say aye. Those opposed, no. The motion is agreed to. The House stands adjourned until Sunday at 1 p.m. Happy Valentine's Day.

